

Challenges for religion Key philosophical and ethical concepts: • Secularism as a mode of thought and being • Tolerance • Freedom of belief • Freedom of expression • Freedom of practice • Equality in society • The value of human life • Self-determination	• The importance of the Christian religious traditions in British society • Christianity as the established religion in a country of diverse religious traditions • The Monarch as Supreme Governor of the Church of England • The role of religion in public life, including: ◦ Bishops in the House of Lords ◦ Christian services to mark key events ◦ Public holidays based on Christian celebrations ◦ Church schools • The concept of secularisation, including: ◦ The place of religion in a secular society ◦ The effects of secularisation on religion ◦ The rise of humanism • Potential clashes between religious and secular values in education, including: ◦ Secular ethics and values in school ◦ Faith schools • Potential clashes between religion, tradition and secular law, including: ◦ Religious teachings and attitudes about marriage ◦ Responses to forced, arranged and child marriages ◦ Religious attitudes to equality ◦ Potential clashes with equality laws • Potential clashes between religious teachings and scientific development in medical ethics, including: ◦ Euthanasia and the right to die ◦ Abortion ◦ Issues of genetic manipulation ◦ The creation of life Learners should be aware of the justifications Christians give for different views, attitudes and understandings, from the perspectives of different Christian denominations.	• The Church of England ‘Facts and Stats’ • The British Humanist Association • The National Secular Society • The Sunday Assembly • Education Act of 1988: RE and Assemblies • Statements from the Roman Catholic and Anglican churches on potential clashes between religious teachings and scientific development in medical ethics • Abortion • Education • SPUC • Exodus 20:13 • Psalm 139:13
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